

INFOSYS'S CAMPUS CONNECT Launched 2004

With its unique initiative, Infosys has reached out to 502 engineering colleges in India as well as from abroad while benefiting 3,000 faculty members in an effort to firm up India's soft skills

SKILLED EFFORT

Tech titans have often talked of the skill gap created by the disconnect between the demand of the IT industry and the supply of industry-ready recruits. As India moves towards becoming a global leader in IT, management and engineering colleges along with industry have realised the need to scale up quality students to meet the growing demand of the sector. Infosys's Campus Connect programme, started in 2004, is a unique industry-academia initiative that aims to overcome this by creating a vibrant pool of future engineering graduates.

Of the roughly two lakh engineering graduates that roll out of Indian technical schools every year, only

about 1 per cent are from the top engineering schools like the IITs. The programme aims to be a forum where the best practices of the corporate world can be shared with the graduates and the faculty of colleges with less established resources. Programmes such as soft skill development, faculty enabling and students' industry visits are aimed at aligning the needs of the colleges, the faculty and the students. "It is our way of walking the talk on building the much-needed link between industry and academia. The focus is on enhancing the industry readiness of the students

coming out of our educational institutions," says CEO and MD of Infosys Kris Gopalakrishnan, who is an IIT-M graduate and one of the seven founding members of the \$4-billion Bangalore-headquartered IT firm.

Besides an interactive curriculum for the graduates, the programme also includes training sessions and seminars for the faculty so that they are equipped to give students an industry perspective. Campus Connect so far has been able to reach out to 502 engineering colleges across India apart from institutions in countries such as China, Malaysia and Mexico. It has been normal practice for most IIT graduates to leave Indian shores for greener pastures in developed nations like the US or Europe forcing a severe talent crunch in India. With Campus Connect, however, Infosys aims to solve the problem as its five-year-old initiative has already benefited 3,000 faculty members and about 58,000 students.

by Stephen David

750
engineers are
produced for
every million
who graduate in
the US annually.
India produces
only 200 for
every million.

DEEPAK G. PAWAR



"The Campus Connect programme is our way of walking the talk on building the much-needed link between industry and academia."

Kris Gopalakrishnan 53, CEO & MD